

Grade 5 FAST ELA Reading

2025 Released Test Items

All trademarks and trade names found in this publication are the property of their respective owners and are not associated with the publishers of this publication.

Introduction

Section 1008.22(8), Florida Statutes (F.S.), requires the Department to publish each statewide, standardized assessment administered, excluding retakes, at least once on a triennial basis, with the initial publication occurring after the Spring 2024 test administration. The initial publication of assessments was required to include, at a minimum, the grade 3 Mathematics and English Language Arts (ELA) Reading assessments, the grade 10 ELA Reading assessment and the Algebra 1 End-of-Course (EOC) Assessment. Per statute, released content must have appeared on tests in the administration year immediately preceding release. Based on those requirements, below is a proposed timeline for the release of operational tests beginning with the 2023–24 school year.

June 2024	June 2025	June 2026
Grade 3 Mathematics & ELA Reading	Grade 5 Mathematics & ELA Reading	Grade 4 Mathematics & ELA Reading
Grade 6 Mathematics & ELA Reading	Grade 8 Mathematics & ELA Reading	Grade 7 Mathematics & ELA Reading
Grade 8 Science	Grade 5 Science	Biology 1 EOC
Grade 10 ELA Reading	Grade 9 ELA Reading	
Algebra 1 EOC	Geometry EOC	
Civics EOC	U.S. History EOC	
Annually: Grades 4–10 Writing prompts and individual student responses		

The purpose of the released tests is to promote transparency in the statewide, standardized assessment program and to increase the comfort level of students and parents with the state assessments. Students, parents, and teachers should use the released tests to better understand the types of items on Florida's K–12 statewide assessments.

Each released test will include content that represents an operational test blueprint for each respective assessment. The released tests can also be used to illustrate the length of an operational test and the range of difficulties of the questions on that test.

Each released test will include an answer key, the percentage of students that answered that item correctly, the item's reporting category, and the item benchmark information.

Released tests can be accessed through the Sample Items card on the Florida Statewide Assessments Portal.

For more information about K–12 assessments, please visit https://www.fldoe.org/accountability/assessments/k-12-student-assessment/.

For questions related to this document or released tests in general, please contact Assessment@fldoe.org.

Beach Bummers

by the National Park Service

1 It's June and you've been invited to the beach. Sweet! You're actually going to visit three different beaches, and they're all pretty secluded. Even better! In fact, these beaches are so isolated you have to take a boat to them. FANTASTIC!

2 As you board, the captain looks over your gear. You packed a bathing suit?! Won't be needing that where *you're* going. (Did he just sneer?) Beach umbrella? That'll just take up deck space. Snorkel and flippers? Nothing doing.

3 In their place you are handed a pair of rubber boots big enough to get lost in, a bright orange padded coat (so much for the tan), a giant plastic trash bag and a trash picker. . . .

No Ordinary Beach Outing

4 This, as you have no doubt realized, is no ordinary beach trip. Alaska's Kenai Fjords National Park is sending a team of researchers out to get acquainted, one might say, with its beach trash. Plastic bottles, Styrofoam, fishing gear, lost shoes, old cars . . . in fact, pretty much any man-made item you can think of is winding up on park beaches. Scientists call this "marine **debris**," and it can be found almost anywhere. Even beaches humans can't get to are often littered with our throw away items! How do we know? Pilots can see the debris from the air!

5 How does it get there? It can be left by people using the beach, but more often it is brought by ocean currents and then is sort of coughed up by the wind and waves. And how did it get into the ocean? Have you got a mirror? Most of us contribute to the problem, even if we live hundreds of miles from the ocean! . . .

6 Not only is it a bummer to see this waste on the park's remote beaches, marine debris harms the environment and is creating a whale of a problem for wildlife. Turtles get hopelessly tangled in fishing nets. Whales gulp down plastic bags thinking they're snacking on squid. Birds swoop down for some tasty fish eggs and wind up with gullets full of plastic bits. Talk about filling up on junk food! And, just like us, if they eat too much of it, they aren't hungry for real food. . . .

Getting Down and Dirty

7 So this summer, as they have for many years, a team of park rangers will board the park's research boat and get after some trash. They'll go to the same three beaches they go to each year and, using

GPS devices, mark off the same two sections on each, one near the water's edge and one farther up where plants grow. These sections are called "transects." Then they'll walk slowly along these transects looking for trash. Every item, and its location, is carefully logged on a data sheet. Found a piece of rubber? Would that be a flip flop, glove, tire or "other"? Plastic? Tell us more—is it a bag, bottle, 6-pack ring, straw or something else?

8 Why not just bag it all up and toss it? Well, we are better equipped to solve problems when we know more about them. And this is where science comes in. Scientific research helps us get to the bottom of things, like, say, piles of trash. In this case it can tell park management exactly what's coming in, how fast it's piling up, and where it might be coming from. With these details they can begin to work on keeping the debris out of the ocean in the first place. If, for example, the team pulls in a lot of fishing nets and buoys (and boy *do* they!) the park can talk to the fishing industry about how they dispose of old equipment. They can also notify local governments, who may create regulations to protect the ocean. Single-use plastic items, like water bottles and plastic bags, are even more common. One solution? Put refillable water stations in park visitor centers to encourage people to carry reusable bottles.

9 Once all that information is logged, the item goes into the trash bag, which is loaded onto the boat for later disposal. . . .

Bagged That One!

10 Great! You've got it all bagged. But what if there's too much to fit on the boat (remember—they grumbled about your beach umbrella taking up space)? Like any good action **flick**, you need a helicopter! In this case, you'll need one to airlift the bags onto a barge (you did order the barge, didn't you?). Then the barge hauls it away to . . . uh oh, don't dust your hands off yet! Not many landfills want this stuff. Those that will take it sometimes *double* their fees.

11 As you can see, cleaning up marine debris is difficult and expensive. That's why so many organizations, including the National Park Service and **NOAA** are trying to stop the problem at the source.

Turning the Tides

12 Fortunately we humans are as good at solving problems as we are at creating them. And you don't have to be an adult to help find solutions. Middle school students in Massachusetts started a "Skip the Straw" campaign, high school students in Washington State are becoming Marine Debris Ambassadors, and kids the world over are participating in beach cleanups . . . .

13 In other words—who can help solve this problem? Go get the mirror again. Maybe your generation will turn the tide on marine debris!

Glossary

debris: scattered pieces of waste or broken materials

flick: movie

NOAA: The National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration

"Beach Bummers" by the National Park Service. In the public domain.

1. What is the meaning of the word participating as it is used in paragraph 12?

Ⓐ dividing up

Ⓑ speaking out

Ⓒ joining together

Ⓓ competing alone

2. How does the author support the argument that it is important to study the debris found on beaches?

Ⓐ by stating that learning more about debris can change where fishing boats go in the ocean

Ⓑ by suggesting that sharing information about debris can let people know what equipment to use

Ⓒ by suggesting that identifying types of debris and where it comes from can lead to specific solutions

Ⓓ by stating that sorting and labeling debris can prove that plastics are the biggest problem on beaches

3. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

Which text structure is used in the section **No Ordinary Beach Outing**?

Ⓐ sequence

Ⓑ comparison

Ⓒ cause and effect

Ⓓ problem and solution

Part B

How does the text structure in Part A add to the author's purpose?

Ⓐ It shows how letting debris get into the ocean can harm marine animals.

Ⓑ It explains different ways people can reduce the amount of marine debris.

Ⓒ It highlights the fact that debris is the same on beaches all over the world.

Ⓓ It gives a detailed description of how each type of debris gets into the ocean.

4. What details does the author include to support the central idea that anyone can help solve the problem of marine debris?

Ⓐ names of organizations that are doing research

Ⓑ lists of places where local people clean up beaches

Ⓒ explanations of the process that park rangers follow

Ⓓ descriptions of the activities children have organized

5. Read this sentence from the passage.

"In fact, these beaches are so isolated you have to take a boat to them." (paragraph 1)

What is the meaning of isolated as it is used in the sentence?

Ⓐ covered by plants

Ⓑ dangerous to reach

Ⓒ larger than average

Ⓓ separate from others

6. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is a central idea of the passage?

Ⓐ Many different materials people make can become marine debris.

Ⓑ There is so much marine debris that it can be seen from far away.

Ⓒ Special tools are needed for removing marine debris from beaches.

Ⓓ Cold beaches usually have more marine debris than warm beaches.

Part B

Select the sentence that supports the central idea in Part A.

4 Ⓐ This, as you have no doubt realized, is no ordinary beach trip. Ⓑ Alaska's Kenai Fjords National Park is sending a team of researchers out to get acquainted, one might say, with its beach trash. Ⓒ Plastic bottles, Styrofoam, fishing gear, lost shoes, old cars . . . in fact, pretty much any man-made item you can think of is winding up on park beaches. Ⓓ Scientists call this "marine debris," and it can be found almost anywhere. Ⓔ Even beaches humans can't get to are often littered with our throw away items! Ⓕ How do we know? Ⓖ Pilots can see the debris from the air!

7. How does the author support the idea that cleaning up marine debris can be expensive?

Ⓐ by explaining that people keep a continuous record of debris

Ⓑ by describing the steps of throwing away the collected debris

Ⓒ by saying that only scientists have solutions for marine debris

Ⓓ by listing the clothing that needs to be worn to collect marine debris

8. Read the sentence from the passage.

"Not only is it a bummer to see this waste on the park's remote beaches, marine debris harms the environment and is creating a whale of a problem for wildlife." (paragraph 6)

How does the phrase "a whale of a problem" add to the author's argument?

Ⓐ It shows that marine debris harms some animals more than others.

Ⓑ It adds another animal to the list of those affected by marine debris.

Ⓒ It highlights the fact that the problem of marine debris is very serious.

Ⓓ It focuses on the specific areas of the ocean that contain marine debris.

Passage 1: A Day in the Life of a Park Ranger in Glacier National Park

by the National Park Service



1 Glacier National Park is a busy place in the summer. There are about 2 million visitors that come to enjoy the beauty of Glacier. To help us protect this special place, Glacier has several types of park rangers. Some rangers protect Glacier National Park by enforcing its laws and regulations. . . . Some rangers protect the park by educating visitors about all the wonderful things about Glacier National Park. Some rangers patrol the trails to make sure that visitors are safe and trails are in good condition.

Protecting the Park and People

2 A ranger's job is to protect all that is within Glacier National Park from harm. This can be very exciting because you never know what you might do in a day. A ranger might help a visitor who needs some directions to the Visitor Center. . . .

Search and Rescue

3 A ranger can be called on a Search and Rescue day or night, so they must always have their rescue gear ready to go. Rescues can take a couple hours to several weeks. . . .

Interpretation

4 The job of some rangers is to teach the visitors all about Glacier National Park. They may work in a Visitor Center, lead hikes, give programs to kids, and perform campfire talks and slide programs in the evening. Their job is to help visitors understand and care about Glacier National Park.

Backcountry Ranger

5 Backcountry rangers hike the trails every day. They check the trails to make sure that there are no hazards, such as a tree that is across the trail. If a tree is across the trail, the ranger will use a saw to cut it out. The rangers also talk to visitors that are backcountry camping and make sure they are safe and following the rules. Backcountry rangers will often use horses when they travel the trail. Sometimes rangers will spend up to 10 days camping before coming out of the backcountry.

Excerpt from “A Day in the Life of a Park Ranger in Glacier National Park” by the National Park Service. In the public domain. Image: Wikipedia/Tobias Klenze. Licensed under the Creative Commons CC BY-SA 4.0 License.

Passage 2: Behind the Scenes: Life as a Park Ranger

by Lacey Thomas

Lacey Thomas is a park ranger at Carlsbad Caverns in New Mexico. It has three caves that are open to the public.



6 In American society a common conversation opener is asking what someone does for a living. Teachers often hear, “You must love kids!” after they answer. Doctors might hear, “Would you look at _____ on my _____?” When I tell people I’m a park ranger, almost invariably I hear, “That’s the coolest job ever!”

7 It’s true. Being a park ranger is a pretty cool job. You get to move to and live in exciting places. You meet people from all over the world. You gain an array of knowledge. . . .

8 However, it's not all fun and games. Being a ranger requires you to be quick on your feet, adaptable, and possibly most important of all . . . patient. Being personable and resilient in the face of challenges are also important characteristics. Rangers are called on to complete a variety of different tasks every day. Those duties fluctuate not only each day but from park to park as well. Some skills are useful at every unit. Others are not so much. For instance, being able to answer the same questions over and over again at the information desk is useful everywhere. The ability to predict geysers hasn't been all that helpful since I left Yellowstone National Park.

9 People love to ask what a typical day consists of here at the cave. Like many jobs, there is no such thing as a "typical day." Some days I come to work and watch hundreds of thousands of Brazilian free-tailed bats exit the cave to begin their nightly foraging. Some days I come to work, teach people caving fundamentals, and then crawl through the cave with them. Some days I come to work and attend trainings and fill out paperwork. Those days aren't exciting, but they are necessary. . . .

10 Over the years and through the parks, one thing has never changed: people are the best part of this job. This is just one small way of paying you back [for] giving me the privilege of being a National Park Service Ranger.

Excerpt from "Behind the Scenes: Life as a Park Ranger" by Lacey Thomas. In the public domain. Image of Carlsbad Caverns by Peter Jones of the National Park Service. In the public domain.

9. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is the author's perspective of park rangers in Passage 1?

Ⓐ They manage parks in order to keep them open.
Ⓑ They focus on studying nature to protect the parks.
Ⓒ They enjoy using the parks for their own recreation.
Ⓓ They help make the parks more attractive to visitors.

Part B

How does the author develop the perspective in Part A?

Ⓐ by giving examples of how rangers work with visitors
Ⓑ by showing how rangers enjoy the beauty of national parks
Ⓒ by explaining that rangers spend most of their time outdoors
Ⓓ by describing the responsibilities rangers have to care for the parks

10. How does the author develop her purpose in Passage 2?

Ⓐ She shares personal experiences to show the daily life of a park ranger.

Ⓑ She describes types of training to explain the process of becoming a park ranger.

Ⓒ She compares being a park ranger to other jobs in similar fields to point out differences.

Ⓓ She lists ways of how a park ranger interacts with people to encourage more park visitors.

11. Based on Passage 1, fill in the bubbles to show whether the statements summarize the tasks of general park rangers, backcountry rangers, or both.

	General Park Rangers	Backcountry Rangers	Both
They educate visitors and give directions.	Ⓐ	Ⓑ	Ⓒ
They work with children and host special events about topics.	Ⓓ	Ⓔ	Ⓕ
They travel trails on horses and make sure paths are clear.	Ⓖ	Ⓗ	Ⓘ

12. Read this sentence from Passage 2.

"Some days I come to work and watch hundreds of thousands of Brazilian free-tailed bats exit the cave to begin their nightly foraging." (paragraph 9)

Which claim from Passage 2 does this statement support?

Ⓐ Rangers can encounter dangerous situations.

Ⓑ Every day can present unique experiences to a ranger.

Ⓒ People often get excited when they discover what rangers do.

Ⓓ Rangers think that working with people is the best part of their job.

13. How does Passage 1 present information about park rangers differently than Passage 2?

Ⓐ Passage 1 tells what a ranger does at a specific park, while Passage 2 gives examples of rangers at different parks.

Ⓑ Passage 1 gives examples of how the job of a ranger is difficult, while Passage 2 argues that being a ranger is enjoyable.

Ⓒ Passage 1 describes the many places where rangers work, while Passage 2 explains the many tasks rangers do at work.

Ⓓ Passage 1 summarizes what rangers do every day, while Passage 2 gives a personal account of what it is like to be a ranger.

14. What is the meaning of the word <u>array</u> as it is used in paragraph 7 of Passage 2?

Ⓐ a limited amount

Ⓑ a long tradition

Ⓒ a specific type

Ⓓ a wide range

15. Which idea from Passage 1 is presented in the image?

Ⓐ Glacier National Park is a popular place for tourists.

Ⓑ People visit Glacier National Park to enjoy its beauty.

Ⓒ Some trees may fall across trails in Glacier National Park.

Ⓓ Rangers encourage people to care for Glacier National Park.

16. In Passage 2, why does the author describe her job as “not all fun and games” in paragraph 8?

Ⓐ to warn that people should not become park rangers

Ⓑ to express the wish that her job were more enjoyable

Ⓒ to suggest that rangers need more training than they get

Ⓓ to show that she understands that her job can often be difficult

17. Which sentence from Passage 2 supports the central idea that a park ranger's job can be demanding?

Ⓐ "You get to move to and live in exciting places." (paragraph 7)

Ⓑ "Being a ranger requires you to be quick on your feet, adaptable, and possibly most important of all . . . patient." (paragraph 8)

Ⓒ "People love to ask what a typical day consists of here at the cave." (paragraph 9)

Ⓓ "Over the years and through the parks, one thing has never changed: people are the best part of this job." (paragraph 10)

Discontented Dewdrop

by Abbie Phillips Walker

1 One morning a little Dewdrop was resting on the petal of a wild rose that grew beside a river.

2 The sun shining on it made it glisten like a diamond, and a lady who was passing stopped to admire its beauty.

3 "It is the most beautiful thing in the world," she remarked. "See the colors in that tiny little drop. Isn't it wonderful?"

4 "Wonderful," repeated the Dewdrop when the lady had walked away. "If I were like the river I might be wonderful; it is too bad; here I am sitting here while the river can run on and on and see all the sights. It bubbles and babbles as it goes, and that is worth while. I have never a chance to be wonderful. Oh, if I were only in the river water I might be something."



5 Just then a breeze passing heard the little Dewdrop's wish.

6 "You shall have your wish, foolish Dewdrop," she said, blowing gently on the rose, which swayed, and off went the little Dewdrop into the rushing river.

7 "This is like something, being a part of this river," said the Dewdrop as it mingled its tiny drop with the running river. "Now I am worth admiring and can see something of the world."

8 On and on it ran with the water of the river, but it was no longer a Dewdrop; it was a part of the river.

9 “I wish I could stop for a minute so some one might admire me,” said the silly little drop, for it thought it could still be seen and was making all the babbling it heard as the river ran along.

10 But no one admired it, nor did it stop. On went the river to a larger river, and by and by it came to the bay and the Dewdrop went rolling into it with the other water.

11 “Surely I am greater now than ever and worth admiring,” thought the drop, but it heard no sweet words such as the lady spoke of the little Dewdrop on the rose by the river.

12 The bay mingled at last with the ocean and little Dewdrop knew at last that it was no longer a thing to be admired for itself alone, but a part of the great ocean. It was completely lost in the vastness of the mighty waters of which it was only a drop.

13 The breeze went whispering over it, calling, “Little Dewdrop, little Dewdrop, where are you?”

14 But the drop answered never a word. It did not even hear the gentle voice of the breeze, so loud was the roar of the ocean.

15 “Come away,” called a loud wind to the gentle breeze; “that is no place for you. I must blow here and make the waves high, and you will never find your little Dewdrop. It has been swallowed long ago by the ocean. Go back to your river and tell the other Dewdrops the fate of their companion.”

16 The gentle breeze went away and the loud wind swept the ocean, making the waves high and the roar louder and louder. The little Dewdrop was there somewhere in the great whole, but it was lost forever in its longing to become great.

17 The gentle breeze went back to the river, and as she sighed around the rose where the discontented Dewdrop had rested she heard another drop say:

18 “Look at the river. Isn’t it big? Here am I only a Dewdrop, so small no one can see me.”

19 “Ah, that is where you are mistaken, my dainty Dewdrop,” said the gentle breeze. “You can be seen now, but if you were to become a part of the river you would never be seen. You would lose your identity as soon as you mingled with the waters of the river. Be your own sweet self and be content with the part you play in this world. You are helping to make it more beautiful by your own dainty beauty. Do not wish to do what only seems a greater thing.”

20 And then she told the fate of the discontented Dewdrop that had wished to become great and how at last it was swallowed by its own greatness, and its dainty beauty which had been so admired no longer remained.

21 “Be content with the small but beautiful part you play in this world,” she told the drop, “and do not long for a greatness which may result in your unhappiness.”

“Discontented Dewdrop” by Abbie Phillips Walker, from *Sandman’s Goodnight Stories*. In the public domain. Graphic created for educational purposes.

18. Read this sentence from the passage.

"'This is like something, being a part of this river,' said the Dewdrop as it mingled its tiny drop with the running river." (paragraph 7)

What does the word mingled mean in this sentence?

Ⓐ joined

Ⓑ ran

Ⓒ talked

Ⓓ touched

19. Fill in the bubbles to show how the Dewdrop changes its perspective in each setting.

	On the Leaf	In the River	In the Ocean
It is excited to see the world.	Ⓐ	Ⓑ	Ⓒ
It is sad to never be looked at again.	Ⓓ	Ⓔ	Ⓕ
It is jealous of the moving water.	Ⓖ	Ⓗ	Ⓘ

20. Read this sentence from the passage.

"'Do not wish to do what only seems a greater thing.'" (paragraph 19)

How does the passage develop the theme in this sentence?

Ⓐ by telling why it is impolite for dewdrops to complain

Ⓑ by describing how a dewdrop learns its lesson too late

Ⓒ by listing the dangers a dewdrop faces during its journey

Ⓓ by explaining why dewdrops should be friends with each other

21. What does the phrase “swallowed by its own greatness” in paragraph 20 reveal about the Dewdrop?

Ⓐ It wanted to be like the river.

Ⓑ It created a problem for itself.

Ⓒ It ignored the ideas of others.

Ⓓ It enjoyed the force of the wind.

22. What does the loud wind tell the gentle breeze to do in paragraph 15?

Ⓐ to keep searching for the Dewdrop

Ⓑ to be proud of the Dewdrop's actions

Ⓒ to share the story of the Dewdrop with others

Ⓓ to honor the Dewdrop's memory among friends

23. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is the theme of this passage?

Ⓐ Appreciating what one has is important.

Ⓑ Helping those in need can be rewarding.

Ⓒ Being happy often comes by showing kindness.

Ⓓ Traveling leads to understanding more about the world.

Part B

Which detail from the passage supports the answer in Part A?

Ⓐ “One morning a little Dewdrop was resting on the petal of a wild rose that grew beside a river.” (paragraph 1)

Ⓑ “Just then a breeze passing heard the little Dewdrop’s wish.” (paragraph 5)

Ⓒ “‘Now I am worth admiring and can see something of the world.’” (paragraph 7)

Ⓓ “‘Be content with the small but beautiful part you play in this world,’ she told the drop . . .” (paragraph 21)

24. What does the setting in paragraph 9 reveal about the Dewdrop?

Ⓐ It feels less in control of the situation.

Ⓑ It enjoys the sounds made by the river.

Ⓒ It misses the friends it had on the petal.

Ⓓ It is pleased with the change in scenery.

25. Read this paragraph from the passage.

2 The sun shining on it made it glisten like a diamond, and a lady who was passing stopped to admire its beauty.

What does the phrase “glisten like a diamond” suggest about the Dewdrop?

Ⓐ It costs a lot.

Ⓑ It looks small.

Ⓒ It sparkles greatly.

Ⓓ It seems very rare.

26. What does paragraph 6 reveal about the breeze?

Ⓐ She prefers dewdrops in water rather than on roses.

Ⓑ She is glad to help the Dewdrop understand its value.

Ⓒ She knows what happens to dewdrops that enter the river.

Ⓓ She is surprised to hear the Dewdrop complaining so much.

27. How do the lady's words in paragraph 3 affect the Dewdrop?

Ⓐ They help the Dewdrop remember why it is beautiful.

Ⓑ They cause the Dewdrop to desire greater adventures.

Ⓒ They encourage the Dewdrop to brag to the other drops.

Ⓓ They give the Dewdrop more information about the river.

Passage 1: from *The Secret Garden*

by Frances Hodgson Burnett

While staying with her uncle, Mary Lennox learns that there is a mysterious garden hidden somewhere nearby. Mary finds a key, and with the help of a robin, she goes looking for the door to the garden that no one has set foot in for ten years.

1 One of the nice little gusts of wind rushed down the walk, and it was a stronger one than the rest. It was strong enough to wave the branches of the trees, and it was more than strong enough to sway the trailing sprays of untrimmed ivy hanging from the wall. Mary had stepped close to the robin, and suddenly the gust of wind swung aside some loose ivy trails, and more suddenly still she jumped toward it and caught it in her hand. This she did because she had seen something under it—a round knob which had been covered by the leaves hanging over it. It was the knob of a door.

2 She put her hands under the leaves and began to pull and push them aside. Thick as the ivy hung, it nearly all was a loose and swinging curtain, though some had crept over wood and iron. Mary's heart began to thump and her hands to shake a little in her delight and excitement. The robin kept singing and twittering away and tilting his head on one side, as if he were as excited as she was. What was this under her hands which was square and made of iron and which her fingers found a hole in?

3 It was the lock of the door which had been closed ten years and she put her hand in her pocket, drew out the key and found it fitted the keyhole. She put the key in and turned it. It took two hands to do it, but it did turn.

4 And then she took a long breath and looked behind her up the long walk to see if anyone was coming. No one was coming. No one ever did come, it seemed, and she took another long breath, because she could not help it, and she held back the swinging curtain of ivy and pushed back the door which opened slowly—slowly.

5 Then she slipped through it, and shut it behind her, and stood with her back against it, looking about her and breathing quite fast with excitement, and wonder, and delight.

6 She was standing *inside* the secret garden. . . .

7 It was the sweetest, most mysterious-looking place anyone could imagine. The high walls which shut it in were covered with the leafless stems of climbing roses which were so thick that they were matted together. Mary Lennox knew they were roses because she had seen a great many roses in India. All the ground was covered with grass of a

wintry brown and out of it grew clumps of bushes which were surely rosebushes if they were alive. There were numbers of standard roses which had so spread their branches that they were like little trees. There were other trees in the garden, and one of the things which made the place look strangest and loveliest was that climbing roses had run all over them and swung down long tendrils which made light swaying curtains, and here and there they had caught at each other or at a far-reaching branch and had crept from one tree to another and made lovely bridges of themselves. There were neither leaves nor roses on them now and Mary did not know whether they were dead or alive, but their thin gray or brown branches and sprays looked like a sort of hazy mantle spreading over everything, walls, and trees, and even brown grass, where they had fallen from their fastenings and run along the ground. It was this hazy tangle from tree to tree which made it all look so mysterious. Mary had thought it must be different from other gardens which had not been left all by themselves so long; and indeed it was different from any other place she had ever seen in her life.

8 "How still it is!" she whispered. "How still!"

9 Then she waited a moment and listened at the stillness. The robin, who had flown to his treetop, was still as all the rest. He did not even flutter his wings; he sat without stirring, and looked at Mary.

10 "No wonder it is still," she whispered again. "I am the first person who has spoken in here for ten years."

11 She moved away from the door, stepping as softly as if she were afraid of awakening someone. She was glad that there was grass under her feet and that her steps made no sounds. She walked under one of the fairy-like gray arches between the trees and looked up at the sprays and tendrils which formed them.

12 "I wonder if they are all quite dead," she said. "Is it all a quite dead garden? I wish it wasn't." . . .

13 But she was *inside* the wonderful garden and she could come through the door under the ivy any time and she felt as if she had found a world all her own.

Excerpt from *The Secret Garden* by Frances Hodgson Burnett. In the public domain.

Passage 2: Foreign Lands

by Robert Louis Stevenson

Up into the cherry tree
Who should climb but little me?
I held the trunk with both my hands
And looked abroad on foreign lands.

I saw the next door garden lie,
Adorned with flowers, before my eye,
And many pleasant places more
That I had never seen before.

I saw the dimpling river pass
And be the sky's blue looking-glass;
The dusty roads go up and down
With people tramping in to town.

If I could find a higher tree
Farther and farther I should see,
To where the grown-up river slips
Into the sea among the ships,

To where the roads on either hand
Lead onward into fairy land,
Where all the children dine at five,
And all the playthings come alive.

"Foreign Lands" by Robert Louis Stevenson. In the public domain.

28. What is a theme developed in Passage 2?

Ⓐ Children want to travel more than adults do.

Ⓑ People often escape into fantasy when they are bored.

Ⓒ Climbing trees is an enjoyable way to escape from daily life.

Ⓓ Taking time to look from a different view provides wonderful experiences.

29. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What do both passages have in common?

Ⓐ They describe children who explore gardens.

Ⓑ They describe children who enjoy climbing trees.

Ⓒ They describe children who appreciate peace and quiet.

Ⓓ They describe children who see wonderful things for the first time.

Part B

Which quotation from Passage 2 supports the answer in Part A?

Ⓐ “Up into the cherry tree / Who should climb but little me?” (lines 1–2)

Ⓑ “I saw the next door garden lie, / Adorned with flowers, before my eye,” (lines 5–6)

Ⓒ “And many pleasant places more / That I had never seen before.” (lines 7–8)

Ⓓ “If I could find a higher tree / Farther and farther I should see,” (lines 13–14)

30. Fill in the bubbles to show whether each sentence describes Passage 1, Passage 2, or both passages.

	Passage 1	Passage 2	Both Passages
The main character sneaks into a place.	Ⓐ	Ⓑ	Ⓒ
The main character dreams of imaginary things.	Ⓓ	Ⓔ	Ⓕ
The main character wants to continue exploring.	Ⓖ	Ⓗ	Ⓘ

31. In Passage 1, how does the author use Mary's character to develop the theme that amazing things can be uncovered?

Ⓐ by using her curiosity to lead her to a special place

Ⓑ by emphasizing her bravery to show she is unafraid

Ⓒ by detailing her love for the natural beauty of the garden

Ⓓ by having her question why the plants in the garden are fading

32. In Passage 1, which statement describes how Mary's experience changes how she sees the world?

Ⓐ She begins to become a more caring person.

Ⓑ She discovers the value in something that is imperfect.

Ⓒ She decides that she should spend less time by herself.

Ⓓ She learns that being outdoors is better than being indoors.

33. In Passage 1, which statement describes how Mary views the secret garden?

Ⓐ lonely but lively

Ⓑ strange and dull

Ⓒ scary but peaceful

Ⓓ mysterious and lovely

34. Which **two** sentences should be included in a summary of Passage 2?

Ⓐ A child holds the trunk of a tree.

Ⓑ A child sees a garden full of flowers.

Ⓒ A child concludes that what is seen is not real.

Ⓓ A child pictures a land that is perfect for children.

Ⓔ A child takes a close look at the surrounding world.

35. What is the meaning of tramping as it is used in line 12 of Passage 2?

Ⓐ climbing a steep hill

Ⓑ visiting a familiar place

Ⓒ walking steadily and heavily

Ⓓ searching for something new

36. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

In Passage 1, why does Mary want to return to the garden?

Ⓐ She wants to see the robin again.

Ⓑ She wants to replace the bare plants.

Ⓒ She wants to learn who planted the garden.

Ⓓ She wants to discover more about the garden.

Part B

Which quotation from the passage supports the answer in Part A?

Ⓐ “She put her hands under the leaves and began to pull and push them aside.” (paragraph 2)

Ⓑ “It was the sweetest, most mysterious-looking place anyone could imagine.” (paragraph 7)

Ⓒ “The high walls which shut it in were covered with the leafless stems of climbing roses which were so thick that they were matted together.” (paragraph 7)

Ⓓ “The robin, who had flown to his treetop, was still as all the rest.” (paragraph 9)



SECURITY STATEMENT
All materials in this book are CONFIDENTIAL and must be kept secure at all times. Duplication, reproduction, and other unauthorized use of Florida Statewide Assessments test books and answer books are prohibited. Test security requirements and sanctions for security violations are established by Sections 1008.23 and 1008.24, Florida Statutes, and State Board of Education Rule 6A-10.042, FAC. These test security statutes and rule are reproduced in the Test Administration Manual.

Office of Assessment
Florida Department of Education, Tallahassee, Florida
Copyright © 2025 State of Florida, Department of State